STOP. CHECK. VERIFY. REPORT.

A quick guide to spotting and handling phishing

1 STOP — pause before acting

Be alert to urgency, fear, secrecy, unexpected rewards, gift-card requests, money transfers, password requests or one-time codes. Pressure is a reason to slow down—not a reason to act.

2 CHECK — inspect the details

Read the **full sender address**, not just the display name. Check the real link destination/domain before opening it. Question unexpected attachments, unusual wording, changed payment details and requests that do not fit the normal process. A familiar name can be spoofed.

3 VERIFY — use a separate trusted route

Contact the person or organisation using a phone number, address or website you already know—not details supplied in the suspicious message. Open services through a saved bookmark or by typing the known address. Confirm payment or supplier changes through the normal approval process.

4 REPORT — tell the right people quickly

Use your organisation's approved **Report Phishing** button or IT/helpdesk route. Follow IT's instructions for preserving the message. If you clicked, entered a password, approved an unexpected MFA prompt or sent money, report it immediately. Early reporting helps; there is no blame.

PASSWORDS

Use a unique password for every account. Store passwords only in an organisation-approved password manager.

MULTI-FACTOR AUTHENTICATION (MFA)

MFA adds a second proof of identity. Deny unexpected sign-in prompts. Never share one-time codes with anyone.

WHEN IN DOUBT: Don't click, pay, reply or share information. Ask IT using a contact route you already trust.

Training material for the fictional Greenfield College scenario. All names, addresses, links and examples are fictional; no real person or organisation was targeted.